



LISTENING

#07

1 - In this audio, a customer visits a car rental store to inquire about renting a vehicle. The conversation covers vehicle options, rental requirements, insurance, and the final car selection.

Listen carefully to the audio and answer the following questions in complete sentences.

Renting a car.

1 - What is the name of the store mentioned in the audio?

2 - For how long does the customer intend to rent a car?

3 - What types of vehicles are available for rent at the store?

4 - According to the audio, what are convertibles particularly suited for?

5 - Which vehicle does the customer ultimately decide to rent?

6 - What documents or information were required from the customer in order to complete the rental?

7 - Did the clerk offer the customer rental insurance?

8 - What is the cost of the insurance mentioned in the audio?

DIRECT BOOKINGS WITH THE RENTAL CAR AGENCY...IS IT A GOOD DEAL?

Renting a car can be one of the most frustrating parts of planning a trip. Rates are rarely standardized, meaning one company could offer a significantly different price than the brand down the street. Luckily, there are several car rental websites to help streamline your research process.

Rental car deals have a lot of differentiators: car size and type, pick-up location, cancellation policies and even mileage caps. Like all travel planning, make sure you're comparing apples to apples when you're shopping around. Our favorite rental car websites make it easy to see this information at a glance.

Direct Bookings With the Rental Car Agency**Advantages to Shopping and Booking With a Specific Car Rental Company**

For customers who are loyal to a single rental car program, it can make sense to book directly with the agency.

Pros of Booking Directly With the Rental Car Company

- Discounted rates may be available.
- Paperwork can be completed online and in advance.
- Driver profiles can be stored for the future.

Disadvantages to Shopping and Booking With a Specific Car Rental Company

Limiting your search to a single rental car website won't necessarily be the best option and we typically recommend using meta-search sites when shopping for car rental deals.

Cons of Booking Directly With the Rental Car Company

- Rates may be higher than what you'd find comparison shopping.
- Promo codes may be available through other agencies or websites.
- You may have limited options in car types or locations.

COMPREHENSION QUESTIONS

1 - Why does the text describe renting a car as "one of the most frustrating parts of planning a trip"?

2 - What factors are mentioned as differentiators when comparing rental car deals?

3 - what are the main advantages of booking directly with a rental car company?

4 - According to the text, what risks or disadvantages might travelers face when booking directly with an agency?

5 - What does the expression "comparing apples to apples" suggest in the context of evaluating car rental options?
